Wayne Kim

Interaction Designer & Researcher

waynekimdesigns.com · linkedin.com/in/waynewkim · waynewkim@gmail.com · (310) 308-9150 · Los Angeles, CA

I'm an Interaction Designer and Researcher who builds physical prototypes and tests them with real people. After 9 years in design research and strategy at Designit and early and growth-stage startups, I completed a Master's in Interaction Design at CIID, sharpening my ability to move between research, rapid prototyping, and hands-on fabrication. Building, Testing, Repeating.

SELECTED PROJECTS, 2025

Toilet Paper Elevator

Ambient Technology, Physical Computing

Household resource use made visible: toilet paper becomes an elevator ride past real landmarks on a quiet e-ink screen. I built the Hall effect sensor tracking and CAD-modeled housing in 7 days.

Living.fm

AI Interaction, Computer Vision

Liv, a portable AI home narrator built with a Teachable Machine vision model and ElevenLabs voice, responding to everyday behavior like scrolling or stretching with contextual commentary. Built with Cursor from concept to working prototype.

room_tone

Ambient Technology, Physical Computing

A system that notices when you've sat too long and offers a slow return of light, motion, and sound, no guilt, no reminder. I built the Python state machine with Cursor, driving a motorized disco ball, smart plugs, and Spotify API.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Glorify | Senior UX Researcher

Los Angeles, CA, Feb 2023 – Feb 2024

Grew Glorify's research team from one to three. A study with real small groups showed an early community feature strengthened connection rather than replacing it, convincing leadership to build it — now 1.8M+ users, 1 in 5 daily.

Designit | Design Researcher

Remote / NYC, Aug 2021 – Jan 2023

Global design consultancy. Led end-to-end mixed methods research for Fortune 500 clients and co-facilitated a 3-day, 60-participant design thinking workshop that translated C-suite priorities into product strategy. Also developed Foresight POVs.

RaiseMe | UX Strategist

San Francisco, CA, Dec 2017 – Jun 2020

Redesigned how 330+ college partners received their enrollment data, replacing a manual, error-prone export process with automatic, ready-to-use reports. Cut a weekly task from 15 minutes to 2 and helped retain 90%+ of revenue at risk.

EDUCATION

Copenhagen Institute of Interaction Design (CIID)

Master's in Interaction Design | Sept 2024 – Aug 2025

Spent a year in physical prototyping, working across 3D printing, laser cutting, fabrication, and embedded computing alongside research and interaction design coursework.

Colby College

B.A. in Sociology | Sept 2010 – May 2014

SKILLS

Design: Interaction design, physical computing, sensor-based tracking, rapid prototyping, fabrication, 3D design, Wizard-of-Oz testing, video prototyping, mixed-methods research (diary studies, interviews, usability testing), workshop facilitation, storytelling

Tools: Arduino, Fusion 360, Python, Processing, 3D printing, laser cutting, Cursor, Claude Code, TouchDesigner, Unity, Kinect, Figma, Resolume, DaVinci Resolve